

Course Outline - Leadership Essentials for Middle Managers: Guiding Change from Within

This curriculum outline reflects our intentional investment in middle-manager leadership as a core driver of provider transformation and capacity building. The course is designed to equip emerging and existing middle managers with the tools, knowledge, and applied leadership skills necessary to build organizational capacity for Competitive Integrated Employment (CIE) and Community Life Engagement (CLE), grounded in best practices and aligned with the evidence-based 10 Essential Elements of Provider Transformation.

Module Name	Content Notes	Assignment & Resources
Orientation	What is this course and who should participate? Summary of tips and expectations. Content emphasizes participation. Meet your instructors section.	None
Leadership	5 Leadership Styles (Jim Collins)- <i>Learners identify their style.</i> Differences between being a “leader” or a “manager.”	1. Determine Your Leadership Style 2. Leadership Goal Development
History and Federal & State Landscape	The history and evolution of disability services. Key legislation/policy and their impact on people with disabilities. (Sect 504, 511 & 14(c), DD Act, ADA, Olmstead, reasonable accommodations, WIOA, E1-national and MN, DHS Definition of competitive employment) How history and legislation impact the work you’re doing today.	What is the MN Employment First Policy? Resource: <i>The Path Forward</i> Willowbrook Documentary
Mission, Vision, Values and Realigning Resources	What does your org’s mission, vision and values communicate? What are the elements of successful mission vision and values? How does resource allocation impact transformation? How to align resources with your mission, vision and values. (staffing, middle-manager roles, aligning staff activity with roles, tracking outcomes) What is Organizational Transformation? What resources are needed to make it happen? Video: <i>3 Things that Make a Meaningful Vision</i> Simon Sinek	Organizational Analysis Resource: <i>Aligning Action and Values</i> (Jim Collins)
Best Practices in Employment and Day Services	What are best practices? - Guiding Principles (values, rights, research, evolution and outcomes) - Informed choice - Systemic instruction concepts - Discovery concepts - Guiding employers in inclusive hiring	1. Marc Gold “Try Another Way” 2. Community Employment Resource: DHS’ Day Services Vision , APSE Fact Sheet (Employment First)

	• Emphasizing CLE, skill-building, person centered planning. • Outcome oriented supports What best practices should you use when working with a job seeker with a disability? What is the purpose of the Discovery process? How do Customized Employment strategies differ from other supported employment models? DHS, MDE, DEED braiding CLE Guideposts	
The 10 Essential Elements of Organizational Transformation	What are the 10 essential elements of organizational transformation? (find them here: Agency Change Toolkit) How can managers promote transformational efforts? (Communication strategies, prioritizing training and development, How could you identify the elements your organization should focus on first? How would you use the Agency Change Toolkit? Note: content focuses on translating 10 Elements into practice in day-to-day work.	1. Self-Assessment 10 Essential Elements 2. Agency Change Toolkit Resource: Agency Change Toolkit
Managing Through Change	How to structure staff to best optimize their skills, ability and time. How to create a professional development plan. What supervision styles, tools, and methods you should consider. What are the most effective communication methods. • Cultural considerations • Collaboration Leading Employers through Inclusive Hiring	Motivating Staff Conflict Style
Creating Systems for Quality Improvement	What quality systems are key for your organization? How can you use data to improve outcomes? What data can you use to track performance? Clear and consistent goals. Defining “quality.” BHAG (Big Hairy Audacious Goals) Plan, Do, Check, Act cycle.	Outcomes and Performance Measures